That the Mayor of the first city in India could be treated by the police in this fashion was something which even the Indian public could not stand The police, on the other hand, felt that they could do just as they liked because they would never be called upon to appear before the bar of public opinion

The restricted scope of the amnesty promised under the Pact, caused considerable disappointment among certain sections of the people and alienated the Mahatma still more from the revolutionaries and from trade-union circles, including the friends and followers of the Meerut prisoners If the Mahatma could have secured amnesty for all these classes of prisoners, he would have stood out not only as the representative of the Nationalists but also of the trade-unionists and the revolutionaries, and he could have exerted his influence on them for good The Government, too, if they had taken courage in both hands and opened wide the gates of the prison-house, would have made a magnanimous gesture which would have gone straight into the hearts of the people And they would have lost nothing thereby—because if anyone happened to abuse his liberty, he could again be put back in prison through the help of the Regulation and the Ordinances Since the Mahatma confined himself to the cause of the Satyagrahis, the revolutionaries in prison addressed a letter to Lord Irwin stating that a settlement with Mahatma Gandhi would not necessarily be binding on them and that if His Excellency desired a real settlement of the Indian question, the Government should come to a separate understanding with the Revolutionary Party This letter reached the Viceroy's hands through a prominent Indian politician [1]

This representation was not altogether useless, because a few months later, the Governor of Bengal, Sir Stanley Jackson, made an effort to come to an understanding with the revolutionaries. At his instance the late Mr J M Sengupta went to Buxa Detention Camp in North Bengal and interviewed some of the leaders The result was not unsatisfactory The interviewed prisoners said that they were prepared to discuss terms, but they insisted that the negotiations should be carried on direct with the Government and

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statement before the Magistrate regarding his treatment in the Police Station which was duly recorded After his removal to prison he was X rayed and it was then found that two of the fingers in his right hand had been fractured

[1] I came to know these facts after my release from prison in March 1931.